# 6-Month Smart Contract Auditor Blueprint

Weekly accountability workbook. 16 hours a week, checked every Sunday.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Name** | |
| **Weekly target** | 16 hours per week, in 4 blocks of about 4 hours. You choose the days. |
| **Weekly deadline** | Every Sunday. That is the only date in this plan. |
| **First Sunday** | Sunday, Oct 11, 2026 (end of Week 1) |
| **Last Sunday** | Sunday, Apr 4, 2027 (end of Week 26) |
| **Total** | 26 weeks x 16 hours = 416 hours |
| **Accountability partner** | |

## The plan at a glance

| Phase | Weeks | Focus | Milestone |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | Weeks 1 to 6<br>ends Nov 15 | Foundations and core Solidity | You can read a raw Solidity file and explain every line. 3 projects are live on Sepolia. |
| **2** | Weeks 7 to 14<br>ends Jan 10 | Foundry and how protocols get hacked | You can write a Foundry test that exploits a vulnerable contract and proves the fix. |
| **3** | Weeks 15 to 26<br>ends Apr 4 | Real code and real contests | You have entered several live contests and submitted findings you can defend. |

**How to use this workbook.** Every week has two pages. The first page has your four blocks: write the day, date and hours as you do them, and tick each task. The second page is for your notes and the Sunday check-in. Fill it in on Sunday and send the proof to your accountability partner. On a computer or tablet the boxes and lines are fillable. You can also print it and write by hand.

# Read this first

## How the week works

Your goal is **16 hours a week**, split into four blocks of about 4 hours. The plan does not pin any block to a day. You write in the day and date yourself as you finish each block. The only fixed date is **Sunday**, the end of each week, when you complete the check-in, count your hours and send proof of work to your accountability partner.
Week 1 is assumed to run Monday, Oct 5 to Sunday, Oct 11, 2026. If you start earlier, hours you do before Oct 5 count toward Week 1.

## What to realistically expect

416 hours is a serious commitment, and it buys you real depth: three past-contest simulations and several live contests. By Week 26 you should be **contest-ready and have live contest experience**. A first paid finding is possible but not guaranteed. Most beginners need more than one contest cycle, and payouts are lumpy. Your record of showing up is the thing you control.

## Ground rules

- ☐ **Sunday is the deadline.** The check-in is done and proof is sent by the end of Sunday, every week.
- ☐ **Be honest about hours.** Log the hours you actually worked. A weekly total of 12 honest hours is worth more than 16 invented ones.
- ☐ **Never a zero week.** On a bad week, do at least 8 hours, tick what you finished, and mark the check-in Partly.
- ☐ **Unfinished tasks carry over.** Write them in the carry-over box at the bottom of next week's task page. Do not pile up more than one week of carry-over; if you do, cut scope at the next checkpoint.
- ☐ **Two weeks under 12 hours in a row?** Talk to your accountability partner and adjust the plan together.
- ☐ **Do not skimp on JavaScript or TypeScript.** Deployment scripts, front ends and off-chain bots are written in it, and you must be able to read them.
- ☐ **Use AI to explain, not to find bugs.** Ask it to explain a concept you are stuck on. Do not let it do your bug hunting. Automated tools already catch the shallow bugs; your value is understanding business logic.
- ☐ **Write things in your own words.** Notes you copy teach you nothing.

# My commitment

Fill this in before Week 1. Sign it. Give a copy to your accountability partner.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Where I will work** | |
| **Why I am doing this** | |
| **My accountability partner (name and contact)** | |
| **How I will report each Sunday** | |
| **Reward at each checkpoint** | |
| **Reward at Week 26** | |
| **If I miss a week** | |

Signed: _____ Date: _____

## Safety rules for the whole 6 months

- [ ] Use a **burner wallet** with testnet funds only. Never keep real funds in your development wallet.
- [ ] Never type your seed phrase into a website, chat, or file. Never share it with anyone, including anyone claiming to be support.
- [ ] Never pay a fee to unlock a job, bounty or airdrop.
- [ ] Be careful with "job offers" that ask you to clone and run code from an unknown repo. This is a common way to steal wallets. Use a throwaway virtual machine or decline.
- [ ] Test exploits only on local forks, testnets or your own deployments. Never attack a live contract, and follow each bounty program's rules exactly.

# Scoreboard

Fill one row each Sunday. Photograph this page and send it with your proof.

| Wk | Sunday | Hours (of 16) | Blocks done | Dues done | Sent | CP |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Oct 11, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 2 | Oct 18, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 3 | Oct 25, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | **CP 1** |
| 4 | Nov 1, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 5 | Nov 8, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 6 | Nov 15, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | **CP 2** |
| 7 | Nov 22, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 8 | Nov 29, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 9 | Dec 6, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 10 | Dec 13, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | **CP 3** |
| 11 | Dec 20, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 12 | Dec 27, 2026 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 13 | Jan 3, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 14 | Jan 10, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | **CP 4** |
| 15 | Jan 17, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 16 | Jan 24, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 17 | Jan 31, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 18 | Feb 7, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | **CP 5** |
| 19 | Feb 14, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 20 | Feb 21, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 21 | Feb 28, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 22 | Mar 7, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | **CP 6** |
| 23 | Mar 14, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 24 | Mar 21, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 25 | Mar 28, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| 26 | Apr 4, 2027 | | ☐☐☐☐ | ☐ | ☐ | **CP 7** |

Running total: _____ of 416 hours  Weeks with dues done: _____ of 26

## PHASE 1 | Foundations and core Solidity

Weeks 1 to 6 | ends Sunday, Nov 15, 2026

**Goal:** Understand how Ethereum works and write clean contracts before you try to break them.

**Milestone:** You can read a raw Solidity file and explain every line. 3 projects are live on Sepolia.

### WEEK 1 Setup and how Ethereum works

Ends Sunday, Oct 11, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Link to your audit-journal repo and your Sepolia transaction hash.

**BLOCK 1** | Setup and tooling — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Create a GitHub repo called **audit-journal**. Every note, contract, test and write-up goes here from now on.
- [ ] Install VS Code and Node.js (LTS). Confirm with node -v and npm -v in a terminal.
- [ ] Create a burner wallet (MetaMask or Rabby) for **testnets only**. Write the seed phrase on paper, never in a file or chat.
- [ ] Add the Sepolia network and claim free test ETH from a faucet.
- [ ] Set up one folder per week in the repo (week-01, week-02 and so on) for notes and code.

**BLOCK 2** | How the chain works — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read on ethereum.org: Intro to Ethereum, Accounts, Transactions, Blocks, Gas.
- [ ] Learn the core ideas: hash, public and private key, signature, block, proof of stake.
- [ ] Send a small Sepolia transaction. Find it on Sepolia Etherscan and identify from, to, value, nonce and gas used.
- [ ] Write a one-page note in your own words: what happens between pressing Send and the transaction being final.

**BLOCK 3** | First steps in Solidity — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Open remix.ethereum.org. Compile and deploy the default Storage contract to the Remix VM. Call store() and retrieve().
- [ ] CryptoZombies Lesson 1, all chapters.
- [ ] Write a counter contract from a blank file: increment, decrement (revert below zero) and a getter.
- [ ] Deploy the counter to Sepolia and call it from Etherscan.

**BLOCK 4** | Consolidate — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] CryptoZombies Lesson 2, all chapters.
- [ ] Write notes: value types, reference types, and what public, external, internal and private mean.
- [ ] JS/TS check: refresh async/await, promises, objects and arrays. Note the gaps to fix later.
- [ ] Commit the week's notes and code to audit-journal.

## WEEK 1 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Oct 11, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Oct 11, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 2 Solidity core

Ends Sunday, Oct 18, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Etherscan link to your verified SimpleBank on Sepolia.

**BLOCK 1** | Data structures — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] CryptoZombies Lessons 3 and 4.
- [ ] Study mappings, structs, arrays and enums. Write a tiny contract that uses each one.
- [ ] Learn storage vs memory keywords and when each is required.

**BLOCK 2** | Control flow and errors — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Study modifiers, events, require, revert and custom errors.
- [ ] Learn msg.sender, msg.value and block.timestamp, and where each one comes from.
- [ ] Start the free Cyfrin Updraft Solidity course (Remix section). Follow along in your own editor.

**BLOCK 3** | Build SimpleBank — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Build SimpleBank in Remix: deposit ETH, check balance, withdraw. Use a mapping, events and a modifier.
- [ ] Deploy to Sepolia and verify the source on Etherscan.
- [ ] Keep this contract. You will attack it in Week 9.

**BLOCK 4** | Attacker mindset and JS/TS — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Write 5 ways someone could abuse SimpleBank.
- [ ] Write a Node script (ethers.js or viem) that prints the Sepolia balance of your burner wallet.
- [ ] Commit everything to audit-journal.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 2 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Oct 18, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Oct 18, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 3 Project 1: ERC-20 token

Ends Sunday, Oct 25, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Etherscan link to your ERC-20 and the repo commit.

**BLOCK 1** | Study — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read the ERC-20 standard (EIP-20) and the OpenZeppelin ERC20 docs.
- [ ] Learn inheritance, interfaces and abstract contracts. Note how override and super work.
- [ ] Write a note: what each ERC-20 function is supposed to guarantee.

**BLOCK 2** | Build from scratch — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Write an ERC-20 in Remix with no libraries: balanceOf, transfer, approve, allowance, transferFrom and events.
- [ ] Test each function and each revert path by hand.

**BLOCK 3** | Compare with OpenZeppelin — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read OpenZeppelin's ERC20.sol line by line. List every difference from your version.
- [ ] Fix your version to handle the edge cases you missed (zero address, allowance handling).

**BLOCK 4** | Deploy and checkpoint — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Deploy your token to Sepolia. Add it to your wallet and transfer some to a second address.
- [ ] Write a Node script that reads the token's name, symbol and balanceOf.
- [ ] Fill in Checkpoint 1.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 3 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Oct 25, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Oct 25, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## CHECKPOINT 1

Sunday, Oct 25, 2026

Tick only what is true. If a box stays empty, that is your plan for the next week, not a failure.

- [ ] I wrote and deployed an ERC-20 without copying code.
- [ ] I can explain every line of my token contract out loud.
- [ ] audit-journal has notes and code for Weeks 1 to 3.
- [ ] I logged at least 40 of 48 hours.

**What feels solid now?**

**What is shaky, and how will I fix it?**

**Am I on track? What will I cut or change to stay on track?**

- [ ] Checkpoint photo or screenshot sent to my accountability partner.

## WEEK 4 EVM internals and Project 2 Ends Sunday, Nov 1, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Etherscan link to your voting contract plus your storage slot notes.

**BLOCK 1** | Storage layout Day Date Hours

- [ ] Learn how state variables map to 32-byte storage slots, including packing of small types.
- [ ] Learn how mapping and dynamic array slots are computed (keccak256 of key and slot).
- [ ] Write a worked example by hand for one of your contracts.

**BLOCK 2** | Memory, calldata and gas Day Date Hours

- [ ] Read raw storage from one of your deployed contracts (Remix debugger now, or cast storage after Week 7).
- [ ] Skim evm.codes: SLOAD, SSTORE, CALL, DELEGATECALL and their gas costs.
- [ ] Gas experiment: deploy a packed and an unpacked struct and compare the gas of the same writes.
- [ ] Write a note: storage vs memory vs calldata and when each is used.

**BLOCK 3** | Project 2: voting system (build) Day Date Hours

- [ ] Write the spec first: proposals, registered voters, one vote each, deadline.
- [ ] Build the contract in Remix with events and custom errors.

**BLOCK 4** | Project 2: finish Day Date Hours

- [ ] Add a result function and finish all events.
- [ ] Manually test each revert path: double vote, vote after deadline, unregistered voter.
- [ ] Deploy to Sepolia and verify the source.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 4 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Nov 1, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Nov 1, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 5 Sending ETH and Project 3 — Ends Sunday, Nov 8, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Etherscan link to your crowdfunding contract plus your list of abuse cases.

**BLOCK 1** | ETH transfers and external calls — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Study receive(), fallback(), payable, and the differences between transfer, send and low-level call.
- [ ] Read the Solidity docs section on Security Considerations.
- [ ] Study delegatecall and how it runs code against the caller's storage.
- [ ] Write down: in SimpleBank, which line is the dangerous external call, and why?

**BLOCK 2** | Project 3: crowdfunding pool (build) — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Spec: goal amount, deadline, contribute(), refund if the goal is missed, withdraw for the owner if reached.
- [ ] Build it in Remix with events and custom errors.

**BLOCK 3** | Project 3: finish — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Test the success path and the failure path by hand.
- [ ] Deploy to Sepolia and verify the source.

**BLOCK 4** | Attacker mindset — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] For each of your 3 projects, write 5 ways someone could abuse it.
- [ ] Add a README to each project and commit everything to audit-journal.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 5 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Nov 8, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Nov 8, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 6 Phase 1 review

Ends Sunday, Nov 15, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Your line-by-line explanation file and a photo of Checkpoint 2.

**BLOCK 1** | Read professional code — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read OpenZeppelin Ownable.sol and ReentrancyGuard.sol line by line.
- [ ] Skim OpenZeppelin ERC721.sol and note what differs from ERC-20.

**BLOCK 2** | Read production code — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read WETH9 and explain each function in your own words.
- [ ] Note anything you do not understand and look it up.

**BLOCK 3** | Explain every line — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Pick an unfamiliar simple contract (100 to 150 lines, for example a vesting or staking example from OpenZeppelin or Solidity by Example).
- [ ] Write a line-by-line explanation with no help. Then check it against the docs.

**BLOCK 4** | JS/TS and checkpoint — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Write a Node script that transfers your token from your burner wallet.
- [ ] Catch up on any unfinished item from Weeks 1 to 5.
- [ ] Fill in Checkpoint 2.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 6 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Nov 15, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Nov 15, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## CHECKPOINT 2

Sunday, Nov 15, 2026

Tick only what is true. If a box stays empty, that is your plan for the next week, not a failure.

- [ ] 3 projects are deployed and verified on Sepolia (token, voting, crowdfunding).
- [ ] I can read an unfamiliar simple Solidity file and explain every line.
- [ ] I can explain storage slots, gas, and call vs delegatecall.
- [ ] I wrote a JS/TS script that reads from and writes to a contract.
- [ ] I logged at least 80 of 96 hours.

**What feels solid now?**

**What is shaky, and how will I fix it?**

**Am I on track? What will I cut or change to stay on track?**

- [ ] Checkpoint photo or screenshot sent to my accountability partner.

## PHASE 2 | Foundry and how protocols get hacked

Weeks 7 to 14 | ends Sunday, Jan 10, 2027

**Goal:** Move to a professional local toolchain and learn the classic attack classes by exploiting them.

**Milestone:** You can write a Foundry test that exploits a vulnerable contract and proves the fix.

### WEEK 7 Foundry setup and porting

Ends Sunday, Nov 22, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Screenshot of forge test passing on all 3 projects, plus the repo link.

**BLOCK 1** | Install and explore — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Install Foundry with foundryup. Check forge --version, cast --version and anvil --version.
- [ ] Read the Foundry Book: Getting Started and Projects. Run forge init and forge test on the sample project.
- [ ] Understand the layout: src/, test/, script/, foundry.toml, lib/.

**BLOCK 2** | Port Project 1 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Port your ERC-20 into src/ and compile with forge build.
- [ ] Write 5 unit tests: transfer, approve, transferFrom, insufficient balance, insufficient allowance.
- [ ] Run forge test -vvv and read the traces.

**BLOCK 3** | Cheatcodes and Project 2 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn vm.prank, vm.startPrank, vm.deal, vm.warp, vm.roll, vm.expectRevert and vm.expectEmit.
- [ ] Port the voting contract and write a test for every revert path.

**BLOCK 4** | Project 3 and coverage — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Port the crowdfunding pool. Use vm.warp to test the deadline both ways.
- [ ] Run forge coverage. Aim to test every branch of your 3 contracts.
- [ ] Push the Foundry project to GitHub.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 7 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Nov 22, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Nov 22, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 8 Fuzzing, invariants and forking

Ends Sunday, Nov 29, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Your fuzz and invariant tests plus a screenshot of the seeded bug being caught.

**BLOCK 1** | Fuzzing — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read the Foundry Book chapters on fuzz testing.
- [ ] Turn 3 of your unit tests into fuzz tests. Use bound() or vm.assume to constrain inputs.

**BLOCK 2** | Invariants — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Write an invariant test: the sum of all balances equals totalSupply.
- [ ] Learn handler contracts and why they keep invariant runs meaningful.

**BLOCK 3** | Seed a bug — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Make a copy of your token with a deliberate bug.
- [ ] Confirm the fuzzer or invariant test catches it.
- [ ] Journal entry: what did the fuzzer find that a manual test would have missed?

**BLOCK 4** | Forking and Ethernaut — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read the Foundry Book on forking. Get a free RPC key (Alchemy or Infura) and read a mainnet token balance on a fork.
- [ ] Ethernaut levels 0 to 3, solved without hints.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 8 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Nov 29, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Nov 29, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 9 Vulnerability: reentrancy

Ends Sunday, Dec 6, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Your exploit test and both fixes in the repo.

**BLOCK 1** | Study — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn classic, cross-function and read-only reentrancy. Read a summary of The DAO hack.
- [ ] Learn checks-effects-interactions and OpenZeppelin's ReentrancyGuard.

**BLOCK 2** | Exploit — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Rebuild your Week 2 SimpleBank in Foundry as the vulnerable version.
- [ ] Write an attacker contract and a Foundry test that drains the bank.

**BLOCK 3** | Fix and prove — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Fix the bug with checks-effects-interactions and prove the exploit now fails.
- [ ] Fix it a second way with ReentrancyGuard and prove that too.
- [ ] Start your bug notebook (template pages at the back): one entry per bug class.

**BLOCK 4** | Practice — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Ethernaut levels 4 to 6 and the Re-entrancy level.
- [ ] Read 2 hack post-mortems on rekt.news involving reentrancy or access control.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

**WEEK 9** **Notes and Sunday check-in** Ends Sunday, Dec 6, 2026

### What I learned this week, in my own words

### What confused me, and questions to resolve

### Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering

## SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Dec 6, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 10 Access control, proxies, delegatecall

Ends Sunday, Dec 13, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Initialize exploit test and proxy storage-collision demo.

**BLOCK 1** | Access control — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn access control bugs: missing modifiers, tx.origin auth, unprotected initializers, default visibility.
- [ ] Write a vulnerable contract with an unprotected initialize().

**BLOCK 2** | Exploit and fix — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Write a Foundry test that exploits it, then fix it and prove the fix.
- [ ] Add the bug class to your notebook.

**BLOCK 3** | Delegatecall and proxies — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn delegatecall pitfalls. Read OpenZeppelin's docs on Transparent and UUPS proxies.
- [ ] Build a minimal proxy and implementation with mismatched storage layouts and show the collision.

**BLOCK 4** | Practice and checkpoint — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Ethernaut levels 7 to 9.
- [ ] Add each new bug to your notebook: name, root cause, how to spot it, fix.
- [ ] Fill in Checkpoint 3.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 10 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Dec 13, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Dec 13, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## CHECKPOINT 3

Sunday, Dec 13, 2026

Tick only what is true. If a box stays empty, that is your plan for the next week, not a failure.

- [ ] All 3 projects are ported to Foundry with tests.
- [ ] I wrote fuzz and invariant tests and caught a seeded bug.
- [ ] I can exploit and fix reentrancy and an unprotected initializer from a blank file.
- [ ] Ethernaut levels 0 to 9 are complete.
- [ ] I logged at least 144 of 160 hours.

**What feels solid now?**

**What is shaky, and how will I fix it?**

**Am I on track? What will I cut or change to stay on track?**

- [ ] Checkpoint photo or screenshot sent to my accountability partner.

## WEEK 11 Math, precision and signatures

Ends Sunday, Dec 20, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** PoCs for the ERC-4626 inflation attack and a signature replay.

**BLOCK 1** | Math bugs — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn rounding and precision loss, division before multiplication, unchecked blocks and casting bugs.
- [ ] Write a tiny contract with a rounding bug and exploit it in Foundry.

**BLOCK 2** | ERC-4626 inflation — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn the ERC-4626 inflation (donation) attack.
- [ ] Write a Foundry PoC and read how OpenZeppelin mitigates it.

**BLOCK 3** | Signatures — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn ECDSA, EIP-712 typed data, nonces and chain IDs. Learn why a missing nonce allows replay.
- [ ] Write a Foundry PoC of a signature replay against a small vulnerable contract.

**BLOCK 4** | Denial of service and practice — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn unbounded loops and failed external calls inside loops (pull over push).
- [ ] Ethernaut levels 11 and 12.
- [ ] Add these bug classes to your notebook.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 11 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Dec 20, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Dec 20, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 12 DeFi mechanics — Ends Sunday, Dec 27, 2026

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Write-ups for 2 solved Damn Vulnerable DeFi challenges.

**BLOCK 1** | AMMs — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn the constant product formula (x * y = k) and how a Uniswap V2 pair prices swaps.
- [ ] Read the core of Uniswap V2 Pair.sol: mint, burn and swap.

**BLOCK 2** | Oracles, flash loans, lending — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn why spot-price oracles are manipulable and how flash loans make the attack cheap.
- [ ] Learn lending basics: collateral, loan-to-value, liquidation, interest accrual.

**BLOCK 3** | Damn Vulnerable DeFi, part 1 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Set up Damn Vulnerable DeFi (Foundry version).
- [ ] Solve Unstoppable and Truster.

**BLOCK 4** | Damn Vulnerable DeFi, part 2 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Solve Naive Receiver or Side Entrance.
- [ ] Ethernaut levels 13 to 15.
- [ ] Write up each solution: root cause, exploit steps, the fix.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 12 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Dec 27, 2026

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Dec 27, 2026

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 13 Token quirks and MEV

Ends Sunday, Jan 3, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Two more Damn Vulnerable DeFi write-ups and your token quirks note.

**BLOCK 1** | Weird tokens — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn fee-on-transfer, rebasing and tokens with no return value (USDT-style), ERC-777 hooks and ERC-721/1155 callbacks.
- [ ] Write a note: assumptions protocols wrongly make about ERC-20 tokens.

**BLOCK 2** | Front-running and MEV — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Learn sandwich attacks, slippage and deadline parameters, commit-reveal basics and mempool visibility.
- [ ] Write a note: which functions in a typical DEX router are sandwich-sensitive, and why.

**BLOCK 3** | Damn Vulnerable DeFi, part 3 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Solve Selfie.
- [ ] Solve The Rewarder or Puppet.

**BLOCK 4** | Damn Vulnerable DeFi, part 4 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Solve one more challenge and write it up.
- [ ] Check your notebook: at least 8 bug classes with root cause, how to spot it, and fix.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 13 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Jan 3, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Jan 3, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 14 Phase 2 review and milestone

Ends Sunday, Jan 10, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** A public GitHub repo with an exploit, PoC test and README.

**BLOCK 1** | Backlog — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Catch up on unchecked items from Weeks 7 to 13.
- [ ] Redo any Ethernaut or Damn Vulnerable DeFi challenge you skipped.

**BLOCK 2** | Milestone project: exploit — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Pick a vulnerable contract of your choice.
- [ ] Write one Foundry test that exploits it end to end.

**BLOCK 3** | Milestone project: write-up — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Write a README: root cause, impact, proof of concept, recommended fix.
- [ ] Push it to GitHub.

**BLOCK 4** | Review and checkpoint — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Re-read your weakest notes and your bug notebook.
- [ ] Fill in Checkpoint 4.
- [ ] Skim the Phase 3 weeks and note anything to prepare.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 14 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Jan 10, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Jan 10, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## CHECKPOINT 4

Sunday, Jan 10, 2027

Tick only what is true. If a box stays empty, that is your plan for the next week, not a failure.

- [ ] Ethernaut levels 0 to 15 are solved.
- [ ] At least 4 Damn Vulnerable DeFi challenges are solved and written up.
- [ ] I have a public exploit write-up with a Foundry PoC on GitHub.
- [ ] My bug notebook covers at least 8 bug classes.
- [ ] I logged at least 200 of 224 hours.

**What feels solid now?**

**What is shaky, and how will I fix it?**

**Am I on track? What will I cut or change to stay on track?**

- [ ] Checkpoint photo or screenshot sent to my accountability partner.

## PHASE 3 | Real code and real contests

Weeks 15 to 26 | ends Sunday, Apr 4, 2027

**Goal:** Read real audit reports, simulate contests, then enter live ones.

**Milestone:** You have entered several live contests and submitted findings you can defend.

### WEEK 15 Tooling and real audit reports

Ends Sunday, Jan 17, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Triage notes for Slither and Aderyn plus 6 Solodit summaries.

**BLOCK 1** | Static analysis setup — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Install Slither and Aderyn.
- [ ] Run both on your own projects. Triage every finding: real, false positive, or informational.

**BLOCK 2** | Static analysis on real code — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Run both on a small open-source repo.
- [ ] Note what the tools caught and what they could not possibly catch.

**BLOCK 3** | Solodit — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Create a Solodit account and filter for High and Medium findings.
- [ ] Read 6 reports. For each, log root cause, impact, fix, and how you would have found it.

**BLOCK 4** | Audit checklist — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read Trail of Bits Building Secure Contracts (development guidelines and known bugs).
- [ ] Start your one-page audit checklist.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 15 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Jan 17, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Jan 17, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 16 Audit method and simulation 1 — Ends Sunday, Jan 24, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Your simulation 1 findings list and how it compares with the published results.

**BLOCK 1** | Method — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Finish your checklist: scope, docs, actors, assets, invariants, external calls, math, upgradeability, integrations.
- [ ] Learn the workflow: docs, architecture, invariants, line by line, then PoC.

**BLOCK 2** | Simulation 1, first half — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Pick a small past CodeHawks First Flight (200 to 400 lines). Do not read its results.
- [ ] Read the docs, map the architecture, then start the line-by-line review.

**BLOCK 3** | Simulation 1, second half — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Finish the review. Write down every suspected bug.
- [ ] Write a PoC for anything you can. Then stop and do not look at results yet.

**BLOCK 4** | Compare — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Open the published results. Which bugs did you find and which did you miss?
- [ ] For each miss, write why you missed it and which checklist item would have caught it.
- [ ] Learn severity (impact and likelihood) and common rejection reasons: out of scope, known issue, no PoC, informational.

- [ ] **Weekly habit:** read at least 3 Solodit reports (Medium or High) and log them on the Solodit log pages.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 16 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Jan 24, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Jan 24, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 17 Simulation 2 — Ends Sunday, Jan 31, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Simulation 2 comparison and 2 practice reports.

**BLOCK 1** | Prepare — Day ____ Date ____ Hours ____

- [ ] Pick a small past Sherlock contest of a different type (lending, staking or AMM).
- [ ] Read the docs, map the architecture and list the invariants.

**BLOCK 2** | Hunt, first half — Day ____ Date ____ Hours ____

- [ ] Review the highest-risk contracts line by line.
- [ ] Test each suspicion in Foundry before you believe it.

**BLOCK 3** | Hunt, second half — Day ____ Date ____ Hours ____

- [ ] Finish the review and write PoCs. Then stop and do not look at results yet.

**BLOCK 4** | Compare and write — Day ____ Date ____ Hours ____

- [ ] Compare with the published results. Record hits, misses and causes.
- [ ] Write 2 practice reports: title, summary, root cause, impact, proof of concept, recommendation.
- [ ] Attach a Foundry PoC to at least one. Update your checklist.

- [ ] **Weekly habit:** read at least 3 Solodit reports (Medium or High) and log them on the Solodit log pages.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 17 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Jan 31, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Jan 31, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 18 Simulation 3 and off-chain code

Ends Sunday, Feb 7, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Simulation 3 comparison and your updated checklist.

**BLOCK 1** | Off-chain code — Day | Date | Hours

- [ ] Read a deployment script and an off-chain bot in a public repo.
- [ ] List the trust assumptions: keys, oracles, admin actions.

**BLOCK 2** | Simulation 3: prepare — Day | Date | Hours

- [ ] Pick a medium-sized past contest (500 to 800 lines) from Sherlock or CodeHawks.
- [ ] Read the docs, map the architecture and list the invariants.

**BLOCK 3** | Simulation 3: hunt — Day | Date | Hours

- [ ] Review line by line and write PoCs.
- [ ] Then stop and do not look at results yet.

**BLOCK 4** | Compare and checkpoint — Day | Date | Hours

- [ ] Compare with the published results. Update your notebook and checklist.
- [ ] Fill in Checkpoint 5.

- [ ] **Weekly habit:** read at least 3 Solodit reports (Medium or High) and log them on the Solodit log pages.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 18 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Feb 7, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Feb 7, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## CHECKPOINT 5

Sunday, Feb 7, 2027

Tick only what is true. If a box stays empty, that is your plan for the next week, not a failure.

- [ ] I completed and reviewed 3 past-contest simulations.
- [ ] I wrote 2 practice reports, one with a working PoC.
- [ ] I have my own one-page audit checklist.
- [ ] I have read at least 15 Solodit reports.
- [ ] I logged at least 264 of 288 hours.

**What feels solid now?**

**What is shaky, and how will I fix it?**

**Am I on track? What will I cut or change to stay on track?**

- [ ] Checkpoint photo or screenshot sent to my accountability partner.

## WEEK 19 Join the arena

Ends Sunday, Feb 14, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Screenshots of your accounts plus the first contest you chose.

**BLOCK 1** | Accounts and calendar — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Create accounts on CodeHawks, Sherlock, Cantina and Immunefi. Complete profiles and join their Discords.
- [ ] Check each platform's live and upcoming contests. Confirm Cantina actually lists open competitions before relying on it.

**BLOCK 2** | Choose and read the rules — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Pick 3 contests across the next 6 weeks. Prefer small scopes. CodeHawks First Flights are ideal.
- [ ] Read the full rules of the first one: scope, known issues, severity rules, submission format.

**BLOCK 3** | Contest 1: preparation — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read all documentation and the README. Map the architecture, actors and assets.
- [ ] Run Slither and Aderyn and triage the output into your notes.

**BLOCK 4** | Contest 1: first hunt — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] List 5 invariants that must always hold.
- [ ] Review the highest-risk contracts (anything that moves funds or changes roles).
- [ ] Test each suspicion in Foundry before you believe it.

- [ ] **Weekly habit:** read at least 3 Solodit reports (Medium or High) and log them on the Solodit log pages.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 19 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Feb 14, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Feb 14, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 20 Live contest 1 — Ends Sunday, Feb 21, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Your submitted findings (screenshots or links).

**BLOCK 1** | Hunt, part 1 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Continue the line-by-line review of the highest-risk contracts.
- [ ] Keep a running list of suspicions and mark each confirmed or dismissed.

**BLOCK 2** | Hunt, part 2 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Review the remaining contracts and integrations.
- [ ] Write PoCs for the strongest suspicions.

**BLOCK 3** | Reports — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Write reports for your best findings. Submit only what you can defend.
- [ ] Check for duplicates and known issues before each submission.

**BLOCK 4** | Submit and log — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Submit before the deadline.
- [ ] Log every submission in the contest log at the back.

- [ ] **Weekly habit:** read at least 3 Solodit reports (Medium or High) and log them on the Solodit log pages.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 20 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Feb 21, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Feb 21, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 21 Results and live contest 2

Ends Sunday, Feb 28, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Contest 1 results log and contest 2 preparation notes.

**BLOCK 1** | Learn from contest 1 Day Date Hours

- [ ] When results arrive, log every accepted and rejected finding and the reason.
- [ ] If results are not out yet, read the public judge comments on similar issues in other contests.
- [ ] Update your checklist and bug notebook.

**BLOCK 2** | Contest 2: preparation Day Date Hours

- [ ] Read the docs, map the architecture, run static analysis and list invariants.

**BLOCK 3** | Contest 2: hunt 1 Day Date Hours

- [ ] Review the highest-risk contracts line by line.
- [ ] Test suspicions in Foundry.

**BLOCK 4** | Contest 2: hunt 2 Day Date Hours

- [ ] Continue the review and write PoCs.

- [ ] **Weekly habit:** read at least 3 Solodit reports (Medium or High) and log them on the Solodit log pages.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 21 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Feb 28, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Feb 28, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 22 Finish contest 2

Ends Sunday, Mar 7, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Contest 2 submissions.

**BLOCK 1** | Hunt — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Finish the remaining contracts and integrations.

**BLOCK 2** | PoCs and reports — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Write PoCs and reports for your best findings.
- [ ] Check for duplicates and known issues.

**BLOCK 3** | Submit and log — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Submit before the deadline and log every submission.

**BLOCK 4** | Review and checkpoint — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read judged results if available and log accepted and rejected findings with reasons.
- [ ] Fill in Checkpoint 6.

- [ ] **Weekly habit:** read at least 3 Solodit reports (Medium or High) and log them on the Solodit log pages.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 22 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Mar 7, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Mar 7, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## CHECKPOINT 6

Sunday, Mar 7, 2027

Tick only what is true. If a box stays empty, that is your plan for the next week, not a failure.

- [ ] I entered at least 2 live contests.
- [ ] I submitted at least 1 finding I was confident in.
- [ ] My contest log and Solodit log are up to date.
- [ ] I logged at least 328 of 352 hours.

**What feels solid now?**

**What is shaky, and how will I fix it?**

**Am I on track? What will I cut or change to stay on track?**

- [ ] Checkpoint photo or screenshot sent to my accountability partner.

## WEEK 23 Live contest 3 — Ends Sunday, Mar 14, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Contest 3 preparation notes and your hours.

**BLOCK 1** | Contest 3: preparation — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Read the rules, docs and README. Map the architecture, actors and assets.
- [ ] Run Slither and Aderyn and triage the output.

**BLOCK 2** | Contest 3: hunt 1 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] List 5 invariants. Review the highest-risk contracts line by line.

**BLOCK 3** | Contest 3: hunt 2 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Continue the review. Test suspicions in Foundry.

**BLOCK 4** | Contest 3: hunt 3 — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Review the remaining code and write PoCs.

- [ ] **Weekly habit:** read at least 3 Solodit reports (Medium or High) and log them on the Solodit log pages.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 23 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Mar 14, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Mar 14, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 24 Finish contest 3 and find patterns

Ends Sunday, Mar 21, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Contest 3 submissions and a note on what you keep missing.

**BLOCK 1** | Reports and submit — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Write reports, check for duplicates, submit and log.

**BLOCK 2** | Find your patterns — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Review results from contests 1 to 3: what did others find that you missed?
- [ ] Update your notebook and checklist with the bug classes you keep missing.

**BLOCK 3** | Immunefi: choose a program — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Find 2 programs with open-source, in-scope contracts. Read scope, rules and exclusions.
- [ ] Pick one to review.

**BLOCK 4** | Immunefi: first pass — Day _____ Date _____ Hours _____

- [ ] Do a first-pass review. Test only on a local fork or testnet.
- [ ] Never test on live contracts. Follow each program's rules exactly.

- [ ] **Weekly habit:** read at least 3 Solodit reports (Medium or High) and log them on the Solodit log pages.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 24 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Mar 21, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Mar 21, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 25 Immunefi and a fourth contest

Ends Sunday, Mar 28, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Immunefi first-pass notes and contest 4 preparation notes.

**BLOCK 1** | Immunefi: continue — Day | Date | Hours

- [ ] Continue the review. Report only what is in scope and has a working PoC.
- [ ] Write down what you checked and what you ruled out.

**BLOCK 2** | Contest 4: preparation — Day | Date | Hours

- [ ] Choose a contest that closes by the end of Week 26. Read the rules and docs.
- [ ] Map the architecture, run static analysis and list invariants.

**BLOCK 3** | Contest 4: hunt 1 — Day | Date | Hours

- [ ] Review the highest-risk contracts line by line.

**BLOCK 4** | Contest 4: hunt 2 — Day | Date | Hours

- [ ] Continue the review and write PoCs.

- [ ] **Weekly habit:** read at least 3 Solodit reports (Medium or High) and log them on the Solodit log pages.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 25 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Mar 28, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Mar 28, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## WEEK 26 Finish, portfolio and next plan

Ends Sunday, Apr 4, 2027

**Proof to send your accountability partner this Sunday:** Portfolio repo link and your final tally.

**BLOCK 1** | Finish contest 4 Day Date Hours

- [ ] Finish PoCs and reports, submit before the deadline and log every submission.

**BLOCK 2** | Portfolio Day Date Hours

- [ ] Clean up audit-journal: README index, exploit write-ups, PoCs, contest history and bug notebook.
- [ ] Make the repo public and easy for a stranger to read.

**BLOCK 3** | Tally and retrospective Day Date Hours

- [ ] Tally: hours logged, Ethernaut and Damn Vulnerable DeFi solved, contests entered, findings submitted and accepted.
- [ ] Answer the retrospective questions on the Checkpoint 7 page.

**BLOCK 4** | Next 6 months Day Date Hours

- [ ] Write the next 6-month plan: more contests, a Solana and Rust track, or applications for junior auditor roles.
- [ ] Fill in Checkpoint 7 and celebrate. You showed up for 26 weeks.

**Carry-over from last week (unfinished tasks to fit in this week)**

## WEEK 26 Notes and Sunday check-in

Ends Sunday, Apr 4, 2027

**What I learned this week, in my own words**

**What confused me, and questions to resolve**

**Bugs, patterns and snippets worth remembering**

### SUNDAY CHECK-IN | Apr 4, 2027

**Hours logged this week (target 16):** **Blocks completed (of 4):**

**Did I do my dues this week?**

☐ Yes, all of it ☐ Mostly ☐ Partly ☐ No

**What got in the way (if anything):**

**What I will do differently next week:**

☐ Proof sent to my accountability partner. Sent on: ☐ Carry-over written in next week's box

## CHECKPOINT 7

Sunday, Apr 4, 2027

Tick only what is true. If a box stays empty, that is your plan for the next week, not a failure.

- [ ] I entered 3 or more live contests.
- [ ] I did a first-pass review of an Immunefi program.
- [ ] I have a clean public GitHub portfolio.
- [ ] I wrote my plan for the next 6 months.
- [ ] Stretch goal: I have 3 valid findings accepted.
- [ ] I logged at least 390 of 416 hours.

**What feels solid now?**

**What is shaky, and how will I fix it?**

**Am I on track? What will I cut or change to stay on track?**

- [ ] Checkpoint photo or screenshot sent to my accountability partner.

# Final retrospective

**What did I finish that I am proud of?**

**What was hardest, and what did I do about it?**

**Which bug classes do I still miss?**

**What will I do differently in the next 6 months?**

# Bug pattern notebook

One entry per bug class. Start in Week 9. Aim for at least 8 by Week 14 and keep adding through contests.

**ENTRY 1** Bug class:

**Root cause**

**How to spot it in code**

**Where I saw it (Ethernaut, contest, Solodit, hack)**

**Fix**

**ENTRY 2** Bug class:

**Root cause**

**How to spot it in code**

**Where I saw it (Ethernaut, contest, Solodit, hack)**

**Fix**

**ENTRY 3** Bug class:

**Root cause**

**How to spot it in code**

**Where I saw it (Ethernaut, contest, Solodit, hack)**

**Fix**

**ENTRY 4** Bug class:

**Root cause**

**How to spot it in code**

**Where I saw it (Ethernaut, contest, Solodit, hack)**

**Fix**

**ENTRY 5** Bug class:

**Root cause**

**How to spot it in code**

**Where I saw it (Ethernaut, contest, Solodit, hack)**

**Fix**

**ENTRY 6** Bug class:

**Root cause**

**How to spot it in code**

**Where I saw it (Ethernaut, contest, Solodit, hack)**

**Fix**

**ENTRY 7** Bug class:

**Root cause**

**How to spot it in code**

**Where I saw it (Ethernaut, contest, Solodit, hack)**

**Fix**

**ENTRY 8** Bug class:

**Root cause**

**How to spot it in code**

**Where I saw it (Ethernaut, contest, Solodit, hack)**

**Fix**

**ENTRY 9** Bug class:

**Root cause**

**How to spot it in code**

**Where I saw it (Ethernaut, contest, Solodit, hack)**

**Fix**

**ENTRY 10** Bug class:

**Root cause**

**How to spot it in code**

**Where I saw it (Ethernaut, contest, Solodit, hack)**

**Fix**

# Contest and findings log

One row per contest or bounty program. Fill in the results when they are published.

| Contest / program | Platform | Dates | Hours | Findings submitted | Accepted? | What I learned |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
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# Solodit reading log (1 of 2)

Three reports a week from Week 16, six in Week 15. One row per report.

| Date | Report / protocol | Root cause | Impact | How I would have found it |
|---|---|---|---|---|
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# Solodit reading log (2 of 2)

Three reports a week from Week 16, six in Week 15. One row per report.

| Date | Report / protocol | Root cause | Impact | How I would have found it |
|---|---|---|---|---|
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# Resource library

Links change. If one is dead, search the name. Code4rena is winding down, so download any of its public reports you want to study before its archive changes.

## Learn

| | |
|---|---|
| **ethereum.org/developers** | Official developer docs: accounts, gas, EVM, transactions. |
| **CryptoZombies (cryptozombies.io)** | Interactive Solidity basics. Weeks 1 to 3. |
| **Cyfrin Updraft (updraft.cyfrin.io)** | Free Solidity, Foundry and security courses. |
| **Solidity docs and Solidity by Example** | docs.soliditylang.org and solidity-by-example.org. Keep open while coding. |
| **Foundry Book (book.getfoundry.sh)** | The manual for forge, cast and anvil. Weeks 7 to 11. |
| **evm.codes** | Opcode reference with gas costs and a playground. |
| **OpenZeppelin Contracts (docs.openzeppelin.com)** | Reference implementations. Read the source, not just the docs. |
| **Mastering Ethereum** | Free book on GitHub (ethereumbook/ethereumbook). Read chapters as needed. |
| **javascript.info and typescriptlang.org/docs** | JS and TS refreshers for reading scripts and bots. |
| **viem.sh and docs.ethers.org** | Libraries for calling contracts from Node. |

## Practice

| | |
|---|---|
| **Ethernaut (ethernaut.openzeppelin.com)** | Wargame of small vulnerable contracts. Weeks 8 to 12. |
| **Damn Vulnerable DeFi (damnvulnerabledefi.xyz)** | Harder DeFi attack challenges. Weeks 12 to 14. |
| **Secureum (secureum.xyz)** | Security study material and quizzes. |
| **Speedrun Ethereum (speedrunethereum.com)** | Build-focused challenges for extra Solidity practice. |
| **CTFs** | Paradigm CTF and similar events when they run. Good stretch goals. |

## Reading real audits and hacks

| | |
|---|---|
| **Solodit (solodit.cyfrin.io)** | Searchable database of real audit findings. Your weekly habit from Week 15. |
| **Trail of Bits: Building Secure Contracts** | secure-contracts.com. Guidelines and known-bug write-ups. |
| **rekt.news** | Hack post-mortems. One per week is plenty. |
| **Consensys Smart Contract Best Practices** | Classic reference for known attack classes. |
| **Past contest reports** | Sherlock audits on GitHub (sherlock-audit), CodeHawks reports, and the Code4rena archive while it is available. |

## Tools

| | |
|---|---|
| **Foundry** | forge for tests and scripts, cast for chain calls, anvil for a local chain and forks. |
| **Slither (github.com/crytic/slither)** | Static analyzer from Trail of Bits. |
| **Aderyn (github.com/Cyfrin/aderyn)** | Rust-based static analyzer from Cyfrin. |
| **Echidna (github.com/crytic/echidna)** | Optional stronger fuzzer once you outgrow Foundry's. |
| **VS Code Solidity extension** | Syntax, go-to-definition and inline compile errors. |

## Where to compete and earn

| | |
|---|---|
| **CodeHawks (codehawks.com)** | Cyfrin contests. First Flights are built for newer auditors. Start here. |
| **Sherlock (audits.sherlock.xyz)** | Audit contests and bounties. Check the Active and Upcoming tabs. |
| **Cantina (cantina.xyz)** | Competitions and bounties. Verify that public competitions are currently open. |
| **Immunefi (immunefi.com)** | Largest bug bounty platform. Read program scope and rules before touching code. |
| **Superteam Earn (earn.superteam.fun)** | Solana-ecosystem bounties and freelance work, paid in USDC or SOL. |
| **Web3.career and CryptoJobsList** | Job boards for a steadier income while you build your record. |

## After Week 26: optional Solana and Rust track

- [ ] Work through the Rust Book (doc.rust-lang.org/book) chapters 1 to 10 and Rustlings.
- [ ] Read the Solana docs (solana.com/docs) and build one program with Anchor (anchor-lang.com).
- [ ] Study Solana-specific attack classes: missing signer and owner checks, account confusion, arbitrary CPI, PDA seed collisions. Practice with the Sealevel attacks repo and Neodyme's Solana security workshop.
- [ ] Note that Solana consensus is changing: Alpenglow was not yet live on mainnet as of Sept 30, 2026. Apps that only send transactions and read balances need no migration, but services that read block data may.
- [ ] Try small Superteam Earn bounties to build a record while you learn.